

Face Off

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Face Off — Design & Architecture Blueprint

This document translates the reference screenshots and requirements into concrete decisions: information architecture, visual language, component inventory, ad placement strategy, and performance approach. It is the source of truth the Claude Code build prompt (Document 2) is generated from.

1. What each reference actually teaches us

MiMeo (party game — Images 1 & 3): Bold rounded display type, saturated purple→pink→orange gradients, a mascot/trophy hero mark on the home screen, coin currency shown top-right at all times, three big pill CTAs stacked vertically on home. This is the visual register for our **lobby / social screens** — playful, warm, inviting.

Room browser + PIN join (Image 2): Card-based list with a category chip (emoji + label), a stacked-avatar “who’s in the room” indicator, capacity shown as (6/8), and a bright pill “Join” button per card. Separately, a PIN-style 6-box code entry with a “Room found!” confirmation state before the join button activates. **We reuse this exact pattern** for our invite-link/code join flow under the Friends tab.

Podium leaderboard (Image 1, right): 3D-ish podium blocks, crown on 1st place, coin totals per rank, numbered list below the podium for ranks 4+. This becomes our **Profile → Leaderboard** component.

Quiz app light theme (Image 4): Shows the *alternative* register we are explicitly NOT using as primary (too clinical/light for a party game) but we borrow one thing: the **profile stats grid** — four equal stat tiles (wins streak, total matches, friends, high score/win rate) is a clean, scannable pattern we lift directly for our Profile tab.

Dark rewards hub (Image 5): Bottom nav with 5 items collapses info nicely, but more importantly: the **“Gallery of Games” icon grid** and the **XP/rank progress bar with a named tier (“Iron - II”)** are patterns worth borrowing for our future multi-game roadmap (v2) and for a lightweight rank/tier system on Profile even in v1.

Rock-Paper-Scissors duel (Image 6): This is our single most important visual reference. Two limbs (one robotic, one human) facing off across a dark sci-fi/neon arena, countdown timer front and center, move-select icons at the bottom, multiplier/boost cards on the side. **This is the visual language for the actual match/duel screen** — dramatic, dark, neon-accented, tense — a deliberate contrast to the bright playful lobby. Lobby = inviting. Match = high-stakes.

Bow/arrow third-person mobile game (Image 7): HUD conventions worth reusing for any future Bow & Draw mode: top-left health/target-progress combo (3/5), top-right pause, bottom-center aim reticle. Filed for v2, not built now.

Voxel mini-golf (Images 8 & 9): Two patterns worth stealing directly: 1. **Live activity toast** — [Hole 2] TheCodeDan activated Hole Magnet — a small, non-blocking toast that announces what the *other* player just did. This maps perfectly onto Face Off: Opponent raised an eyebrow — dodged! as a toast during a round. 2. **Collapsible scorecard** — a bottom-left panel that expands/collapses via a caret, with a toggle inside it (Show Players: ON/OFF). We reuse this shape for our in-match score panel.

Krunker.io lobby (Image 10): The critical ad-placement lesson: ads are **embedded as a bordered tile alongside a live-streams promo panel**, never a full-screen interstitial on the main menu. The “Store” nav item also carries a badge (★ Summer Finale Spin Available) — a low-pressure, discoverable monetization surface rather than a forced paywall. This directly informs Section 5 below.

2. Information architecture — 3 tabs

Floating bottom nav bar, pill-shaped, auto-hides (slides down + fades) on scroll-down, reappears on scroll-up or on scroll-idle after ~600ms. Rendered above a SafeArea, never overlapping system gesture areas.

- Play** (default tab, home) — random matchmaking entry point, quick-match CTA, live “X players online now” indicator (Krunker’s “Now Playing” pattern), rules/how-to-play access, match history teaser.

2. **Friends** — friends list with online/offline state, invite via link or PIN code (Image 2 pattern), incoming friend requests, per-friend actions (challenge, report, block, unfriend), a dedicated “create private room” flow.
3. **Profile** — avatar + name + level/tier bar (Image 3/5 pattern), stat grid (Image 4 pattern), leaderboard access (Image 1 pattern), subscription management (RevenueCat payroll + manage/restore), cosmetics/inventory, FAQ & support, settings, sign out.

3. Design system

Two palettes, deliberately split by context:

- **Lobby palette** (Play, Friends, Profile — the “social” surfaces): gradient background sweeping violet #5B2A9E → magenta #C6339E → warm orange #F2793E, white/cream cards with soft shadow, coin-gold accent #FFC94A.
- **Match palette** (the live duel screen only): near-black navy #0A0E27 → deep indigo #1B1F4B, neon violet accent #8B5CF6, neon cyan accent #4CD9E8 for “success/dodge” states, hot red #FF4D6D for “hit/loss” states.

Typography: one bold, rounded display face for headlines/scores (matches the MiMeo “chunky” feel), one clean geometric sans for body/UI text. Numbers (scores, coin counts, timers) always use tabular figures so they don’t jitter during countdowns.

Core reusable components (build these once, in `core/widgets`, before any feature screen): - `GradientScaffold` — lobby gradient background wrapper - `CoinBadge` — persistent top-right currency pill - `PodiumLeaderboard` — 3-block podium + ranked list below - `RoomCard` — category chip, stacked avatars, capacity, CTA pill - `PinCodeEntry` — 6-box code input with “found!” confirmation state - `ActivityToast` — small non-blocking event announcement (opponent action) - `CollapsiblePanel` — caret-expandable bottom panel with internal toggles - `StatTile` — the 4-grid profile stat pattern - `DuelVsTransition` — the dramatic pre-match “VS” screen animation - `PrimaryPillButton` / `SecondaryPillButton` — the two CTA button styles

4. Ad & monetization placement (non-intrusive, Krunker-inspired)

Never interrupt an active match. Never full-screen interstitial on app open.

- **Lobby banner tile:** one bordered promo tile on the Play tab, visually matching a `RoomCard` in size/shape so it doesn’t feel like a foreign ad unit — same lesson as Krunker’s streams-panel-adjacent ad tile.
- **Post-match rewarded ad (opt-in only):** on the results screen, an optional “Watch an ad for bonus coins” pill — never pre-selected, never blocking the “Continue” action.
- **Store badge, not popup:** cosmetic drops/sales surface as a small badge on the Profile → Store entry point (Image 10’s “Summer Finale Spin Available” pattern), discoverable, not interruptive.
- **Frequency cap:** rewarded ad offer shown at most once per match, banner tile refresh capped server-side (config value, not hardcoded).
- All ad units flow through RevenueCat Ads — no other ad SDK.

5. Offline/connectivity UX

A `connectivity_plus` stream feeds a global provider. On loss of connection or failed server reachability check: - A bottom sheet **slides up** (not a blocking dialog) with a simple illustration (Lottie), “You’re offline” message, and a “Retry” button. - If offline during an active match, the match pauses locally, the opponent sees an `ActivityToast`-style “Opponent reconnecting...” state, with a reasonable timeout (e.g., 20s) before the match is forfeited gracefully. - Sheet auto-dismisses the instant connectivity is restored and the server health check passes — no manual dismiss needed, but a manual close (swipe down) is still available.

6. Performance approach

- Target floor: **stable 30fps**, camera/gesture pipeline and UI thread kept separate.
- Gesture math (blendshape thresholding, motion-delta calculation) runs on a **Dart isolate**, never on the UI isolate.
- A lightweight device-capability check at first launch (and cached) buckets the device into a performance tier; visual effects (particle bursts, blur, heavy shadow) scale down automatically on lower tiers rather than being all-or-nothing.
- `const` constructors enforced everywhere possible; `RepaintBoundary` wraps any subtree that animates independently (score counters, avatar reactions) so animation doesn’t trigger full-tree rebuilds.